Growth is real. Returns, channel quality and promotions need attention.

Home-goods e-commerce analysis | Orders Jan 2024 - Dec 2025

Data > Evidence > Insight > Implication > Recommendation > Measurement

Revenue grew 21.2% in 2025, well ahead of US e-commerce (+5.4%)

$1.88M
net revenue, 2 years

+21.2%
2025 vs 2024 revenue

49.2%
gross margin (static costs*)

8,456
completed orders

12 of 12 months in 2025 beat the same month of 2024; Nov-Dec peak both years (~22% of annual revenue).

Context: US e-commerce +5.4% in 2025 (Census, 10 Mar 2026). Different scope: whole market, small expanding base here.

*Product costs have no history; the margin gain after the 5% price rise is likely mechanical.

The data is trustworthy after four documented fixes

38

duplicate orders removed - identical in every column

199

missing prices rebuilt - rule matches 100% of known prices

24 > 8

category labels merged - case and spacing only

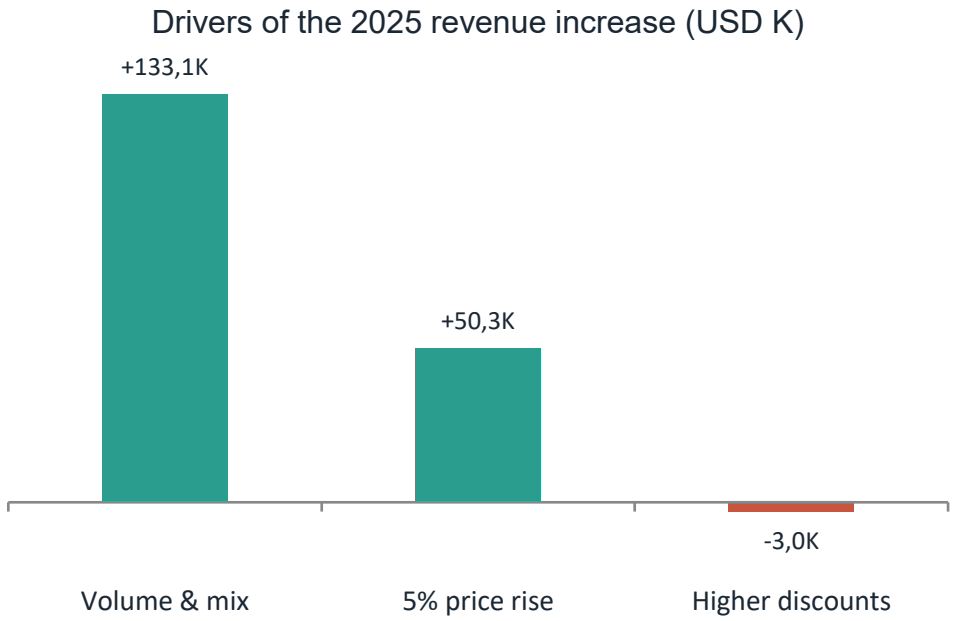
+5%

price rise on 1 Jan 2025 - kept as a business event

Verified

- 16 of 16 validation checks pass
- Zero orphan keys across all joins
- Shipping rule holds on every order (free if net >= $75)
- SQL and Python agree on 11 metrics
- 31 automated tests, mutation-checked

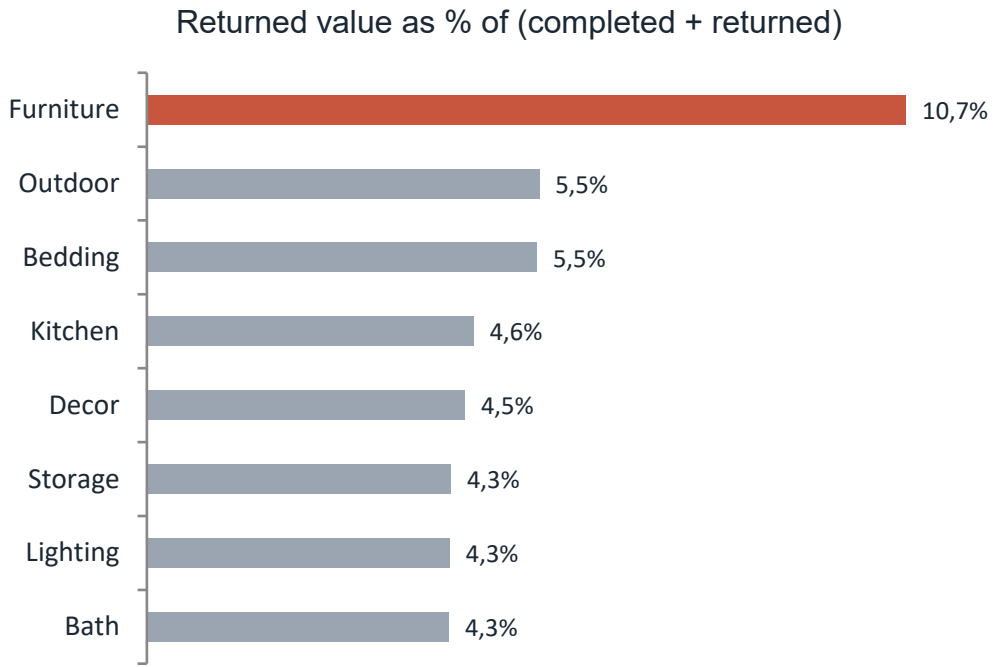
Three-quarters of the $180K gain came from volume and mix, one quarter from price



But growth rides on acquisition

- Signups +81% | active buyers +92%
- Revenue per active buyer $1,002 to $634
- Only 50% of 2024 buyers bought again in 2025
- *Part is mechanical: newer buyers have had less time to reorder.*

Furniture is returned at nearly twice the rate of any other category

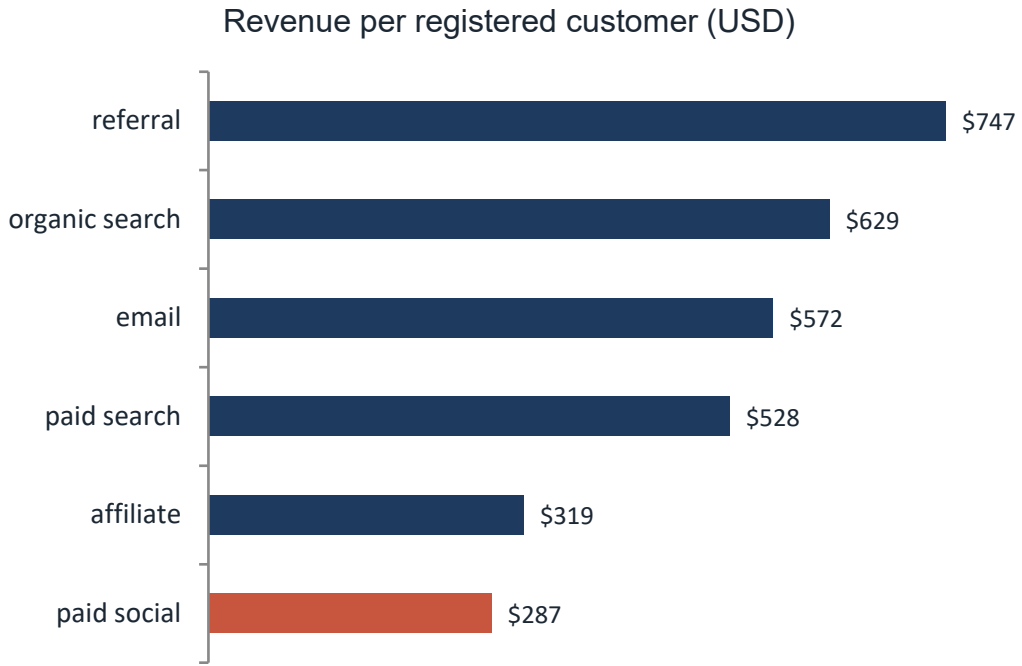


12.1% vs 4.6%

furniture vs other order lines returned

- 33% of all returned value from 17% of revenue
- All 12 furniture products at 7.8%+ (only 6 of 78 others)
- Below NRF's ~19% online average: an internal, relative issue
- Illustrative: matching the rest of the catalog = ~$21.4K retained over 2 years

Paid social supplies 23% of customers but only 13% of revenue

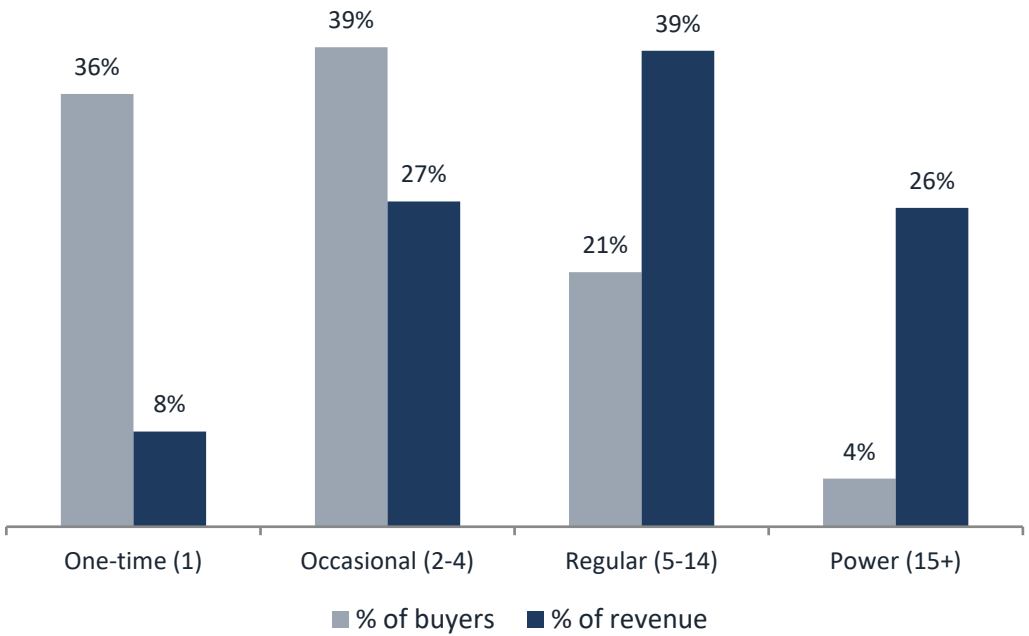


44% ever buy

paid social vs 59-68% in organic, paid search, email, referral

- 90-day activation 33% vs 49-57%
- Referral: $747 per customer, but 10% of base
- **No spend data: profitability unknown**

4% of buyers drive 26% of revenue, while 41.5% of registrants never order

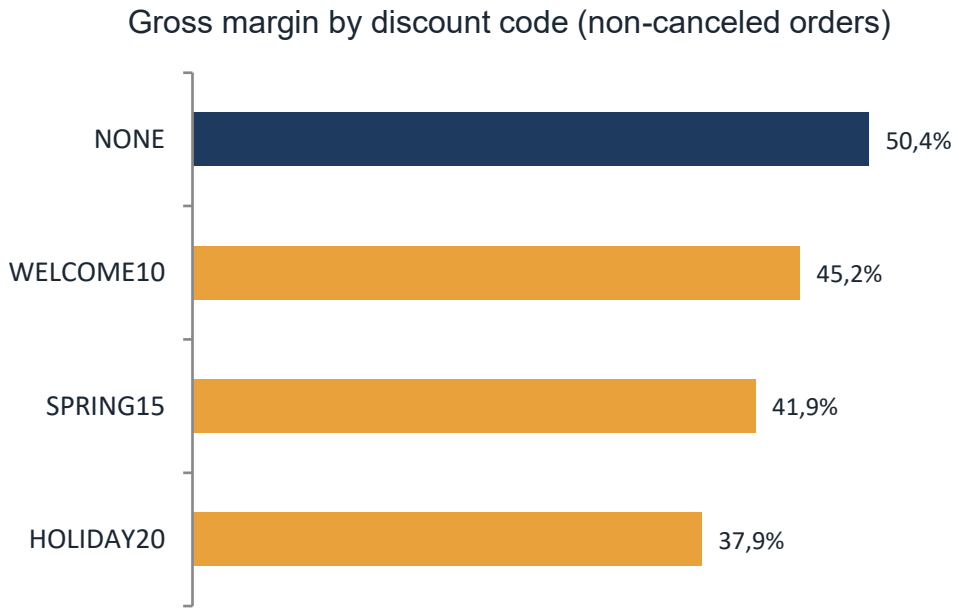


1,494

registered customers never ordered (41.5%)

- Top 20% of buyers = 62% of revenue
- Only 46% order within 90 days of signup
- Power buyers may be resellers (unknown)

Holiday discounts cost 12 points of margin and mostly go to existing customers



$32,001

HOLIDAY20 discounts, two seasons

- Only 22% on first orders: not an acquisition tool
- WELCOME10: 27% first orders; 52 customers reused it
- **Incremental lift is unknown: test it**

Start with diagnostics that cost little, then test before scaling

Quick wins | 0-30 days

- Capture return reason codes
- Pull channel spend; compute CAC and payback
- Limit WELCOME10 to one use per customer

Medium | 30-90 days

- Audit 5 worst-return furniture products (pages, size, damage)
- Activation journey for 1,494 non-buyers; test referral incentive
- Cohort retention view

Longer term

- HOLIDAY20 holdout test before next November
- Keep product-cost history so margin trends are readable

Measure the fixes against today's baselines, and keep the limits in view

KPI	Baseline
Furniture line return rate	12.1%
Paid social buyer rate / revenue per customer	44.2% / $287
90-day activation	46%
2024 buyers who bought again in 2025	50%
Discount as % of gross sales	2.3%
Revenue from top 10% of buyers	44%

Limits

- No marketing spend or return reasons
- Static product costs
- Order-level return status
- Descriptive, not causal or predictive

```
Reproduce: python run_pipeline.py
```